

Ali Hejazizo

AI Lead Engineer

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Highlights

- **AI Leadership:** Founded and built Vendoroo's AI team from scratch, shipping text (LlamaIndex, LangGraph/LangChain, AutoGen) and voice (VAPI, LiveKit, ElevenLabs) agents that power end-to-end property management workflows for **70,000+ residential units**.
- **LLM Expertise:** Fine-tuned LLMs with LoRA and RLHF (GRPO) for a **38 %** user engagement lift at Dippy AI, alongside deep experience building production agentic systems.
- **Technical Architecture:** Designed scalable backends with FastAPI, RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Celery powering real-time agent workflows.
- **Entrepreneurial Impact:** Founded Pytopia, building a custom LMS from scratch that today serves **20,000+ students** across Python, ML, Agentic AI, and Statistics.

Experience

Oct 2024 – **Founding AI Lead, Vendoroo**, Remote

Present Lead a team of AI engineers developing agentic AI solutions that revolutionise communication workflows in real estate property maintenance — essentially *"Cursor for property maintenance"*.

- Built the AI team from scratch and architect the agentic AI framework powering end-to-end property management workflows for **70,000+ residential units**.
- Shipped text agents with LlamaIndex, LangGraph/LangChain, and AutoGen, plus voice agents on VAPI, LiveKit, and ElevenLabs.
- Build intelligent automation that reduces manual processing for property managers by coordinating autonomously between tenants, property managers, and service providers.
- Own the full technical strategy for the AI team, driving products from conception to deployment with high autonomy.

Aug 2024 – Dec 2024 **Senior AI Engineer, Dippy.ai**, Remote

- AI engineer specialising in LLMs and conversational AI for a character-based social platform.
- Fine-tuned LLMs using LoRA and GRPO (Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback), achieving a **38 %** increase in user engagement.
 - Conducted comprehensive model evaluations and A/B testing via Amplitude.
 - Implemented content safety systems for NSFW detection and underage-user protection.

May 2024 – Aug 2024 **Founder in Residence, Antler**, Toronto, Canada

- Selected for Antler's Cohort 6 — a prestigious 4-month startup development programme.
- Received coaching from successful entrepreneurs and industry experts.
 - Developed and validated business concepts through rigorous market-fit analysis.
 - Built a network with fellow founders, investors, and startup ecosystem leaders.
 - Acquired pitching skills and fundraising approaches to accelerate concept-to-business-model.

May 2021 – **Founder, Pytopia**, Remote

- Present Founded Pytopia and built the entire platform end-to-end, designing and engineering a custom Learning Management System (LMS) from scratch that today serves **20,000+ students**.
- Designed and built the full LMS from scratch, owning both the frontend and backend.
 - Developed and delivered computer science courses including Python, Machine Learning, Agentic AI, and Statistics.
 - Implemented a mentorship programme providing personalised career guidance to students.
 - Organised online and in-person events, creating networking opportunities for the community.

- 2021 – 2024 **Senior Machine Learning Engineer**, *Affinity.co*, Remote
- Led a team of 3 engineers building ML systems for a relationship-intelligence CRM platform.
- Built a two-stage structured information extraction system using LLMs, improving accuracy from **54 % to 88 %** (Q&A stage + advanced LLM stage).
 - Created a connection-suggestion feature for investors by identifying overlapping work experiences across millions of professional profiles.
 - Applied NLP to normalise job titles, locations, and industry tags across the platform.
 - Implemented data deduplication using blocking and matching algorithms, significantly reducing redundancy in company and people records.
 - Designed and deployed gender and ethnicity detection models from names and profile images.
- 2018 – 2021 **Machine Learning Engineer**, *AltaML*, Edmonton, Canada
- 3+ years designing and deploying machine learning algorithms across client projects.
- Developed and deployed NLP and Computer Vision models for diverse industry applications.
 - Built and shipped customer-service chatbots to production.
 - Collaborated with cross-functional teams to translate business objectives into technical ML solutions.

Skills

Languages	Python, SQL
AI / ML	LLMs, AutoGen, LlamaIndex, LangChain, Fine-tuning (LoRA, RLHF/GRPO), NLP, Computer Vision
Frameworks	FastAPI, Django, Celery
Databases	PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB
Infra	Docker, Git, Linux

Education

- 2016 – 2020 **M.Sc. Computer Science**, *University of Alberta*, Edmonton, Canada, GPA: 3.9/4
- Thesis: *Combining Variational Sampling and Metropolis-Hastings Sampling for Paraphrase Generation*.
- Supervisor: Denilson Barbosa.

Honours & Awards

- Ranked **1st** in Electrical Engineering (Power Group) among more than 30 students.
- Granted admission by the Talented Student Office of Amirkabir University of Technology for graduate study.